

Diwali: festival, story and meaning

Learning goal: Explain one meaning connected to Diwali.

Words to use

Word	Meaning
Diwali	A festival of lights celebrated by many Hindus, Sikhs and Jains
diya	A small lamp, often made of clay
rangoli	A bright pattern made on the floor to welcome guests
symbol	Something that stands for an idea

Remember

Name one thing light can represent at Diwali. Good overcoming evil, hope or welcome.

Is Diwali celebrated only by Hindus? No. Many Sikhs and Jains also celebrate at this time, with their own meanings.

How to show your learning

Choose one Diwali symbol or practice.

At Diwali, ____ is a symbol of ____ because ____.

Evidence matters

Fictional cases are teaching examples. Historical, geographical and religious claims use the named sources. A model video demonstrates a method.

This is learning about religion and worldviews, not worship. Nobody is asked to share a personal belief, family detail or loss.

Sources: Hindu American Foundation Diwali; Sikh Coalition introduction to Sikh beliefs and practice